A SMARTER LOOP FOR EVERYDAY LEARNING

Learning that lasts.

Turn small learning moments into a clearer sense of capability.

A desk-research heuristic review of Duolingo informs three design hypotheses for LearnLoop, a broader skills-learning platform. These are proposals, not findings from learner testing.

OPPORTUNITY 01
Clear next step
Show the next lesson, time commitment and personal goal together.

OPPORTUNITY 02
Evidence of mastery
Pair completion with specific, demonstrated skills and honest limits.

OPPORTUNITY 03
Flexible momentum
Support weekly rhythms and recovery without punitive pressure.

A learning loop, not a live prototype

SOURCE SCREEN / CONTROL → DESTINATION & STATE

WELCOME	HOME	EXPLORE	COURSE DETAILS	QUIZ REVIEW
Get Started	**Explore tab**	**UX course card**	**Enroll Now**	**Continue to Progress**
Account entry (not shown), then Home after setup.	Opens Explore with all topics selected.	Opens Course Details before enrollment.	Begins lesson 1. Quiz shown after a correct check.	Opens My Learning: UX is 1 of 12 complete.

Shared bottom tabs → Home, Explore, My Learning or Profile; the destination tab becomes active. Sign in → account entry (not shown). Home's Continue lesson → Design Thinking lesson 7 (not shown). These are static intent notes, not connected actions.

DESK-RESEARCH HEURISTIC REVIEW · NOT USER RESEARCH OR A USABILITY TEST
Duolingo 101 · https://blog.duolingo.com/duolingo-101-how-to-learn-a-language-on-duolingo/
Teaching method · https://blog.duolingo.com/duolingo-teaching-method/
LearnLoop / Product design study

DESK RESEARCH / HEURISTIC REVIEW

A strong loop. A different learning context.

What official Duolingo sources describe—and how those patterns inform a broader skills-learning product.

REVIEW LENS	DOCUMENTED DUOLINGO MECHANICS	LEARNLOOP DESIGN INTERPRETATION
A guided way forward	Short interactive lessons sit within a guided unit path.	Carry that clarity into broader skills courses: name the next task and its time cost.
Practice that adapts	Personalized practice and spaced repetition revisit learning over time.	Make practice purposeful by connecting each check to a named skill.
Reasons to return	Streaks track consecutive lesson days; XP, challenges and leaderboards support motivation.	Offer flexible weekly goals as a complementary rhythm, not a claim that Duolingo lacks flexibility.
Progress is not one number	A streak describes consistency, not direct proof of proficiency. Duolingo separately discusses learning effectiveness.	Distinguish activity, completion and demonstrated skills in the progress view.

WHAT THIS REVIEW CAN SAY
Official product mechanics provide design inspiration. They do not establish how LearnLoop learners behave or prove a better experience.

WHAT STILL NEEDS VALIDATION
Test the three hypotheses with learners and accessible task flows. No user complaints, comparative performance claims or measured outcomes are asserted here.

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How well does Duolingo work? · https://blog.duolingo.com/how-well-does-duolingo-work/
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HYPOTHESIS 01

Make the next step feel achievable.

If the next lesson, time commitment and personal goal are visible together, choosing what to do may feel simpler.

From intention to one useful action

PERSONAL GOAL
10 minutes today
Start with the time Maya has available.

→

NEXT LESSON
Turn insights into ideas
8 minutes · Lesson 7 of 10

→

PURPOSE
Use one technique
Apply an idea-generation prompt to a real brief.

APPLIED TO HOME
Your daily goal · 10 minutes

Design Thinking Essentials
6 of 10 lessons · 60% complete
Next: Turn insights into ideas · 8 min
Continue lesson ▷

WHY THIS SCREEN
Home places the personal goal above one primary next lesson. Course Details makes the course commitment explicit before enrollment. This adapts a guided-path pattern; it does not imply Duolingo lacks one.

MEASURES TO VALIDATE · NOT MEASURED OUTCOMES
Observe next-lesson discovery and time to start in a task-based evaluation. Track lesson starts from Home; pair the behavior with a clarity rating rather than assuming intent.

RESPONSIVE & ACCESSIBLE INTENT
Mobile-first hierarchy; cards flex into columns on wider screens. Keep readable text, persistent destination labels and at least 44 px touch-target intent.

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HYPOTHESIS 02

Show what progress means.

If activity and demonstrated skills are distinct, learners may build a more accurate picture of their growing capability.

ACTIVITY & COMPLETION
7 lessons done
Design Thinking: 6 / 10
UX Foundations: 1 / 12
Useful progress, not proof of mastery.

DEMONSTRATED SO FAR
User needs
1 knowledge check passed.
Evidence is limited to this question.
Full course mastery is still ahead.

APPLIED TO QUIZ → MY LEARNING
What comes before sketching solutions?
✓ People's needs and the problem to solve
Selected · Correct · Lesson 1 complete
The rationale connects the answer to a principle. My Learning records one passed check without awarding full-course mastery.

LEARN Meet an idea — Short, focused lesson
→
CHECK Explain a choice — Feedback tied to a skill
→
REVISIT Use it later — Proposed future practice

MEASURES TO VALIDATE · NOT MEASURED OUTCOMES
Use delayed knowledge checks and a practical transfer task to assess retention. Ask learners to distinguish completion from demonstrated skill; a streak alone is not a proficiency measure.

RATIONALE & ACCESSIBILITY
Quiz review adds a reason, not only a result. The selected answer uses an icon and explicit "Correct" text, not color alone. My Learning separates evidence from the completion count.

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HYPOTHESIS 03

Make consistency feel flexible.

If a weekly goal can adapt to real life, learners may return with a clear next step instead of a sense of lost progress.

A rhythm that fits your week — 2 of 3 days
Mon ✓ · Tue · Wed ✓ · Thu · Fri · Sat · Sun
✓ Mon + Wed completed · Fri planned · Other days stay open

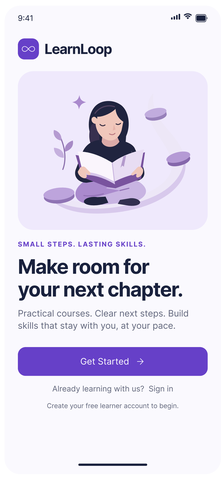
LIFE CHANGES Plans move — A reminder is an invitation.
→
ADJUST Revise the goal — Choose a workable rhythm.
→
RETURN Resume learning — Keep saved course progress.

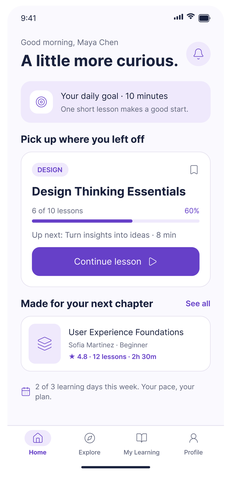
APPLIED TO PROFILE + HOME
Your learning, your way.
3 days a week · 10 minutes a day
A goal to guide you, not grade you.
Reminders · On
Mon, Wed, Fri · 7:00 PM
Settings intent: edit the goal or switch reminders off; saved lessons remain unchanged.

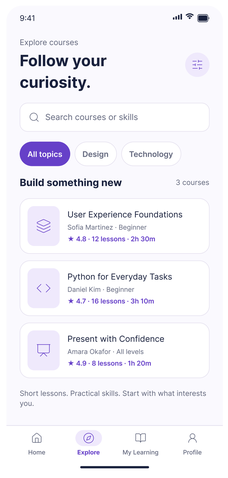
MEASURES TO VALIDATE · NOT MEASURED OUTCOMES
Evaluate return-to-learning after a missed planned day, goal-edit completion and perceived pressure. Interpret return behavior alongside learner feedback, not as proof of wellbeing.

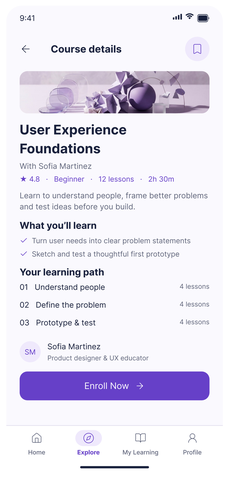
DESIGN RATIONALE & RESPONSIVE INTENT
Duolingo's streak is a consecutive-day consistency signal. LearnLoop proposes a weekly rhythm for broader skills. Profile makes it editable; flexible cards keep the goal readable across widths.

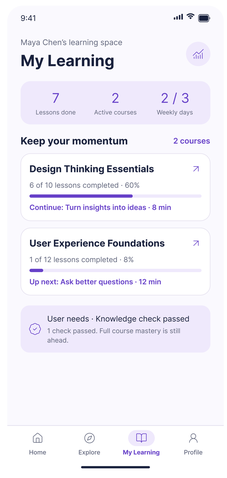
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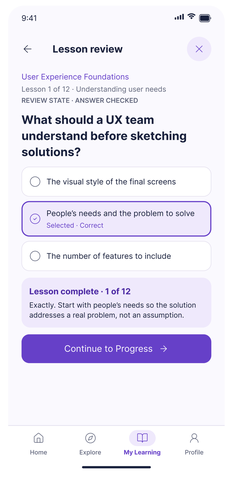


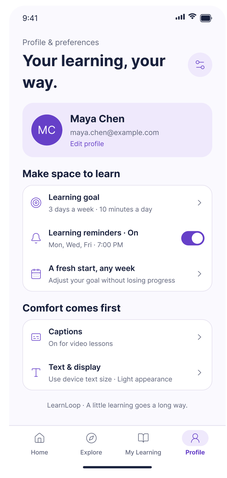












INTERACTION MAP / START AT PX 01 WELCOME

Static design specification • No live links are connected. Add the following actions in the Prototype tab.

01 ENTER & DISCOVER
Welcome · Get Started → PX 02 Home
Any main screen · Explore tab → PX 03 Explore
UX Foundations course card → PX 04 Course Details
Other course cards need matching detail screens before wiring.

02 ENROLL & COMPLETE
Course Details · Enroll Now → PX 06 Lesson Quiz
Lesson shows the correct-answer / completed state.
Continue to Progress → PX 05 My Learning
Progress: UX Foundations 1/12; Design Thinking 6/10.

03 GLOBAL NAVIGATION
Home tab → PX 02 Home
Explore tab → PX 03 Explore
My Learning tab → PX 05 My Learning
Profile tab → PX 07 Profile
Back on Details or Lesson → previous screen.

SETUP NOTES • On tap → Navigate to destination. Set Welcome as the flow starting point. Use the same bottom-nav destinations on every main app screen. The quiz is a success-state preview, not a scored engine.